in South-East Ukraine. Dugin's Neo-Eurasian ideology, besides being an aspect of his personal loyalty to Putin, is a strange synthesis of Russian and Western geopolitics and a messianic view of Russia as the "Eurasian citadel" or the "nucleus of Eurasia" or the "geopolitical Axis of history."[3] It blends Russian Orthodox Christianity, European Neo-Nazism, left-populism, the Byzantine theory of the alliance of spiritual and civil leadership, conservatism, traditionalism, conspiracy theories, and mysticism. It calls for isolationism towards the "Atlantic world" balanced by a partnership with the "East" (i.e., India, China, and the Muslim world), while asserting the uniqueness and superiority of the Russian nation (or even Russians as a race of Aryan origin). The Eurasian sphere controlled by a dominant Russian force should include the former Soviet republics (except the Baltic States), most of the Balkans, part of the Greater Middle East (Turkey, Iran, Lebanon, Syria, Iraq, and Afghanistan), Mongolia, all accompanied by Russia's strengthened influence in India, Pakistan, and parts of Northern China.

Israel would seem to be beyond the limits of this sphere. However, Dugin's 1999 article "Russia Can be Great or Not at All" reveals that Israel is considered by the author to be part of the Russian zone of domination:

> The borders of "Greater Israel" are also very specific: from the Nile to the Euphrates. The daring idea of the most radical Zionists stops beyond these territorial limits. Any further increase of the greatness is considered not through extensive (outer) but through intensive (inner) development of the nation. Through messianic events, miracles and signs that will spread throughout the world by other channels. But the basis is—from the Nile to the Euphrates.[4]

And he further adds:

> [We] never understand the Israeli settlers, to whom it was proposed during the "peace process" to depart (from where?) from the land for which sacred love kept the nation alive during the thousands of years of the Diaspora: after all, the parallel "Greater Israel" did not disappear in any way from the Jewish soul, from Jewish anguish, from the infinite, embittered, sophisticated sorrow of its grief. From the Nile to the Euphrates. In reality or in dreams. . . . But one should reckon with [the fact that] as long as the national ideal of Zionism is alive, nobody will sleep in peace—neither enemies nor friends.[5]

In his recently published book, Dugin overtly includes Israel in the "Eurasian zone" along with the CIS, Russian Diasporas, Christian orthodox peoples and the Turkic regions.[6]

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